

CIS Controls Implementation Plan for a Solo Digital Product Entrepreneur

Introduction

This CIS Controls Implementation Plan outlines practical cybersecurity measures for a sole entrepreneur who creates and sells digital products through Gumroad while using social media platforms, primarily TikTok, to build an audience and generate sales. As the business relies heavily on online platforms, cloud services, and digital assets, it faces risks such as account compromise, phishing attacks, malware infections, data loss, vendor dependency, and business disruption.

The purpose of this document is to identify the most relevant CIS Controls for this business model and provide implementation recommendations to reduce cybersecurity risks, protect business assets, and support business continuity.

CIS Control	Business Asset protected	Risk Addressed	Implementation	Priority	Status
Asset Inventory	Laptop, smartphone, tablet	Unknown or unmanaged devices	Maintain an inventory of all devices used for business activities	high	Planned
Software Inventory	Installed applications	Unauthorized or vulnerable software	Document installed software and remove unnecessary applications	medium	Planned
Data Protection	Digital guides, business files	Data loss, unauthorized access	Store files in encrypted cloud storage and maintain backups	high	Planned
Secure Configuration	Devices and operating systems	Misconfigurations and vulnerabilities	Enable secure settings and automatic updates	high	Planned
Account Management	Gmail, Gumroad, TikTok, Canva	Account takeover	Enable MFA and use a password manager	high	Planned

Access Control Management	Business accounts and services	Unauthorized access	Apply least-privilege principles and avoid account sharing	medium	Planned
Continuous Vulnerability Management	Devices and software	Exploitation of known vulnerabilities	Regularly install security patches and updates	high	Planned
Audit Log Management	Online accounts	Undetected unauthorized activity	Review login activity and security alerts monthly	medium	Planned
Email & Browser Protections	Email accounts and web access	Phishing and malicious websites	Use spam filtering and safe browsing practices	high	Planned
Malware Defenses	Laptop and mobile devices	Malware and ransomware	Install antivirus software with real-time protection	high	Planned
Data Recovery	Business content and digital products	Data loss and corruption	Perform weekly backups and periodically test recovery procedures	high	Planned
Network Infrastructure Management	Home Wi-Fi network	Unauthorized network access	Secure Wi-Fi with WPA3 encryption and strong passwords	medium	Planned
Security Awareness & Skills Training	Business owner	Social engineering attacks	Complete regular cybersecurity awareness training	high	Planned
Service Provider Management	Gumroad, Google, TikTok	Third-party service risks	Review vendor security practices and backup critical data	medium	Planned
Application Software Security	Productivity and content creation tools	Application vulnerabilities	Use trusted software and minimize browser extensions	medium	Planned
Incident	Entire	Application	Create	medium	Planned

Response Management	business	vulnerabilities	procedures for responding to cybersecurity incidents		
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Top 5 Priority Controls

For this business, the most critical controls are:

1. **Account Management** (MFA and password management)
2. **Data Protection** (encrypted storage and backups)
3. **Email & Browser Protections** (phishing prevention)
4. **Malware Defenses** (endpoint protection)
5. **Data Recovery** (backup and recovery capability)

These controls provide the greatest reduction in cybersecurity risk for a solo entrepreneur whose revenue depends on online accounts, digital products, and social media platforms.